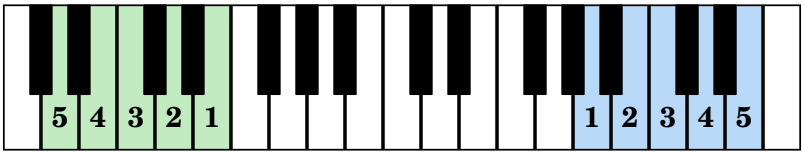
Unit 8

A Minor

New: Minor keys; A minor, the relative minor of C major

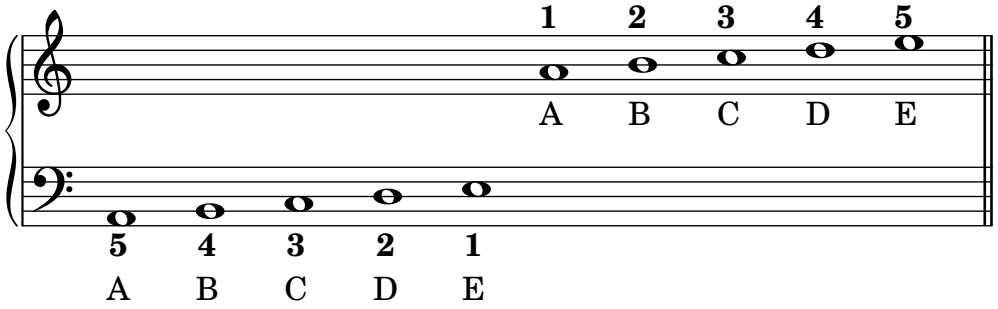
Minor keys have a darker, more serious sound. A minor uses the same notes as C major, with no sharps or flats in the key signature, but its home note is A. Pieces in A minor usually end on A, and the bass often plays A and E.



Middle C

Left hand A position and Right hand A position (green: left hand, blue: right hand)

Your notes



What is new

Major and minor

In a major key the third note above home is four half-steps up (C to E). In a minor key it is three half-steps up (A to C). That one note changes the whole mood.

Relative keys

A minor and C major share a key signature; they are called relative keys. To tell them apart, look at the last note and the bass: A means A minor, C means C major.

A position

Right hand: thumb on the A above middle C (A B C D E). Left hand: finger 5 on the A in the bottom space of the bass staff (A B C D E).

E position

In Part C the right hand also moves down to E position: E F G A B, thumb on the E above middle C.

Reading tips

1. No sharps or flats? Check the last note and the bass to see whether the key is C major or A minor.

2. Let minor music sing: aim for a smooth, legato tone in slurred phrases.

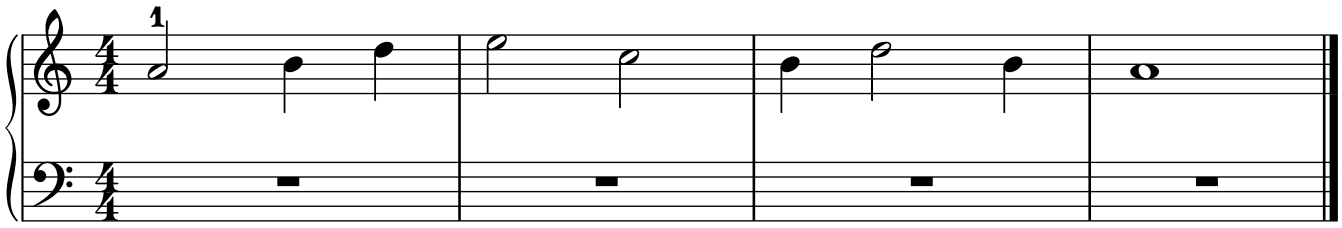
3. Treble A position sits in the upper half of the staff; bass A position starts in the bottom space.

4. Keep going even if a note goes wrong.

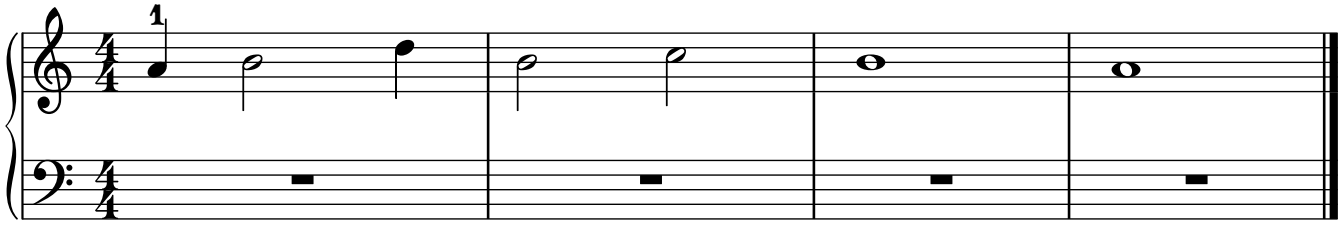
Part A: Right hand in A minor ♩= 60

Right hand in A position, A minor. Metronome 60.

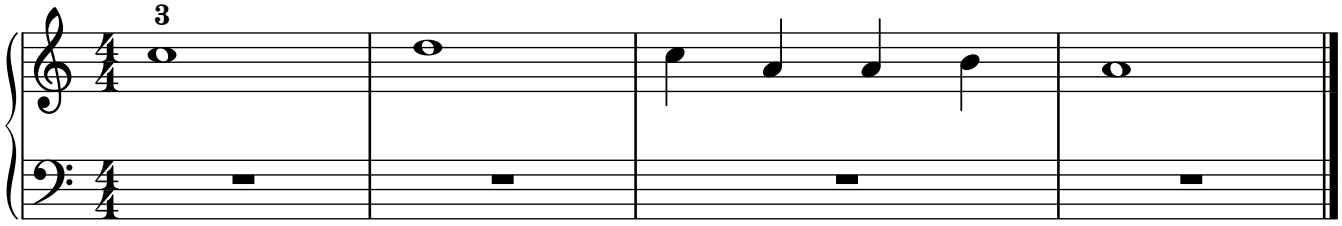
☐ **8.1**



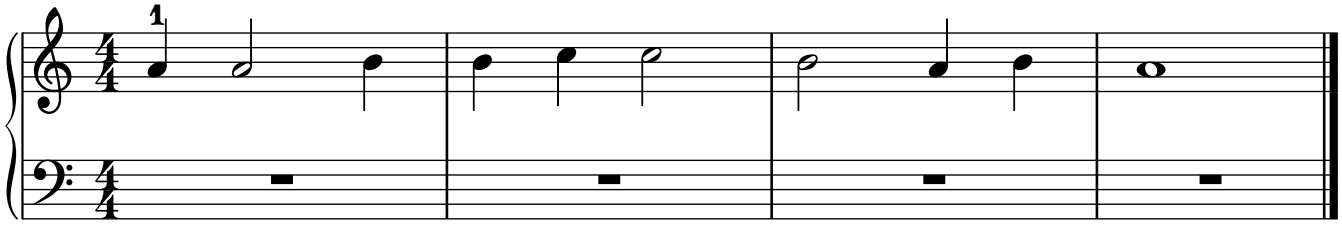
☐ **8.2**



☐ **8.3**



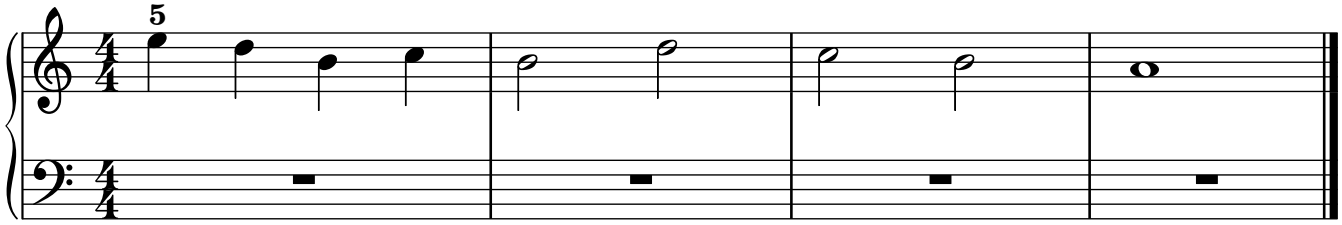
☐ **8.4**



☐ **8.5**



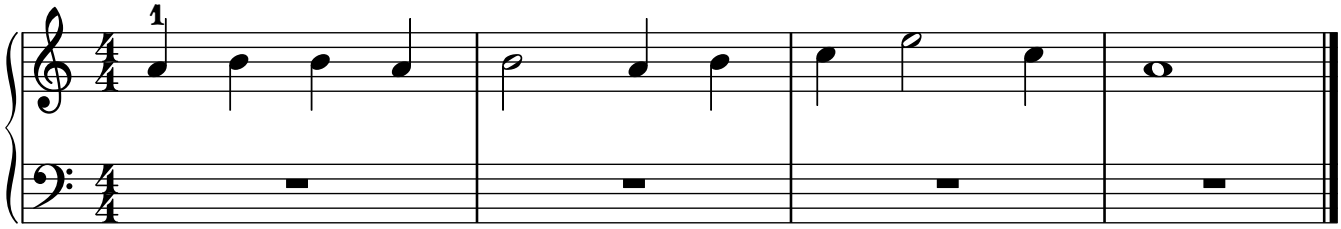
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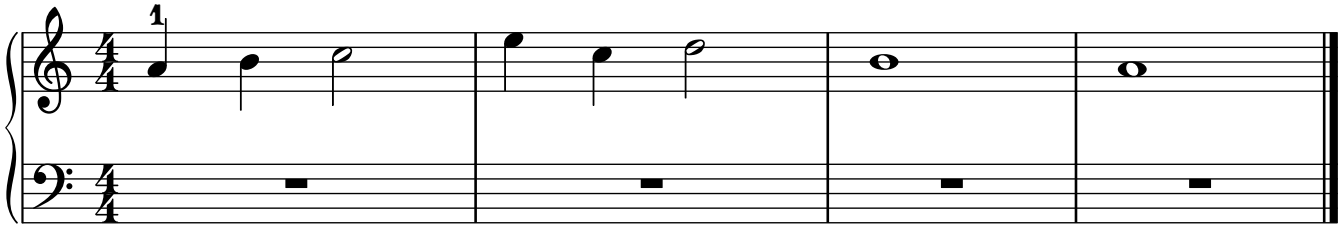
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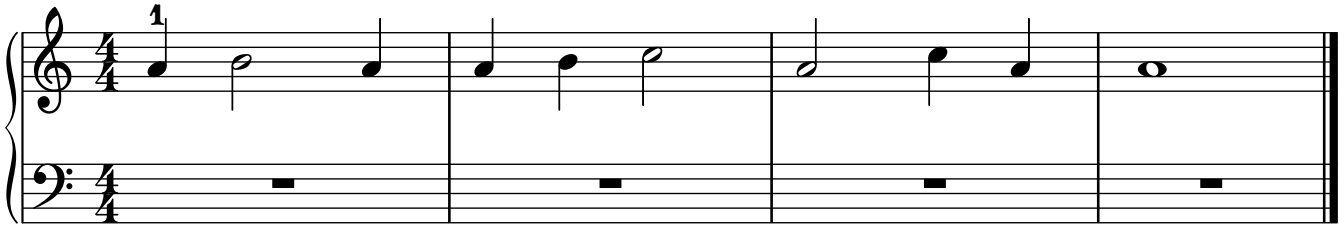
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8.9



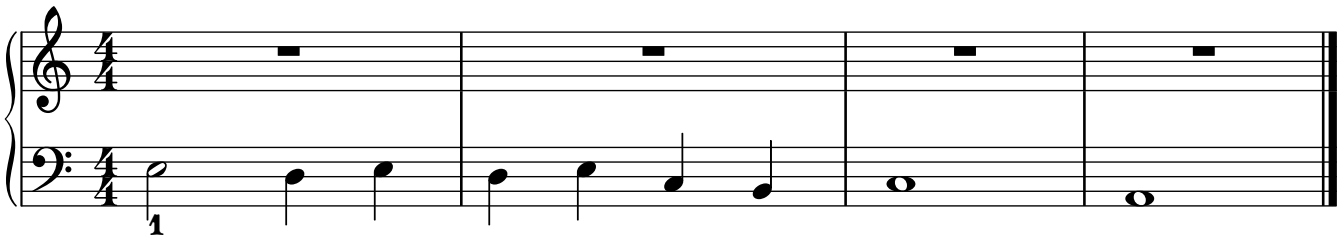
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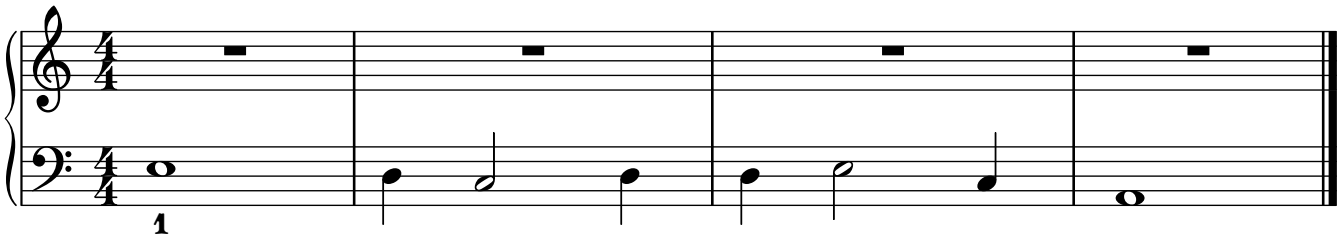
Part B: Left hand in A minor ♩ = 60

Left hand in A position, A minor.

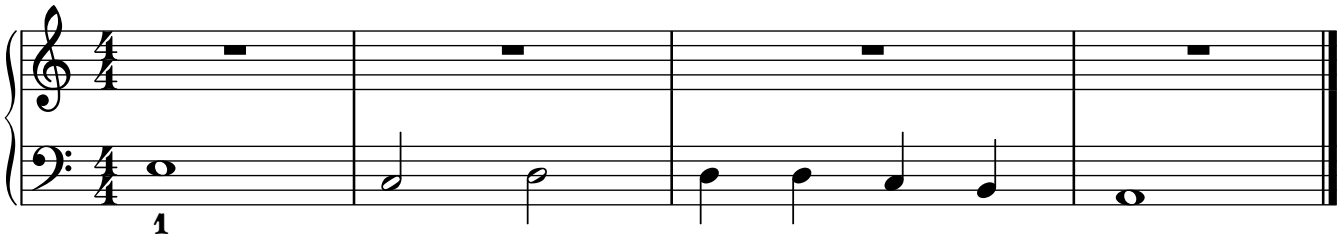
☐ **8.11**



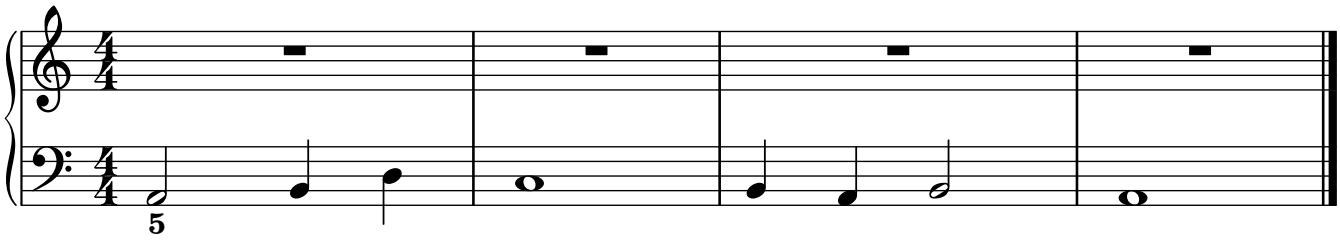
☐ **8.12**



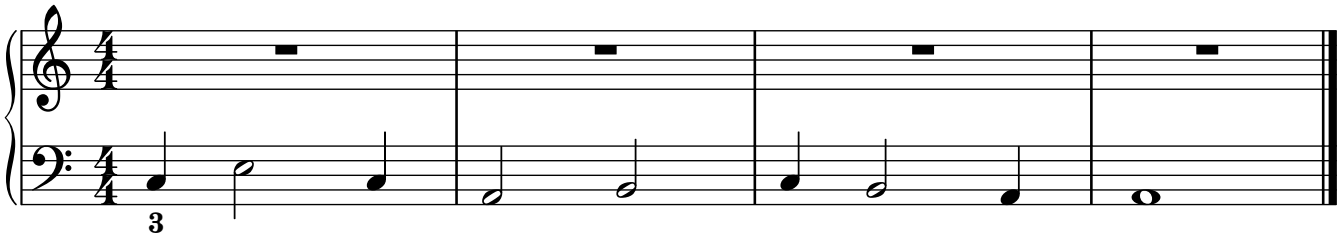
☐ **8.13**



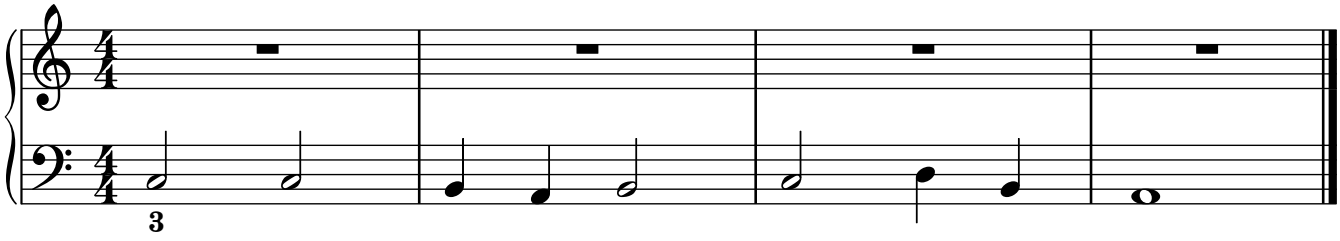
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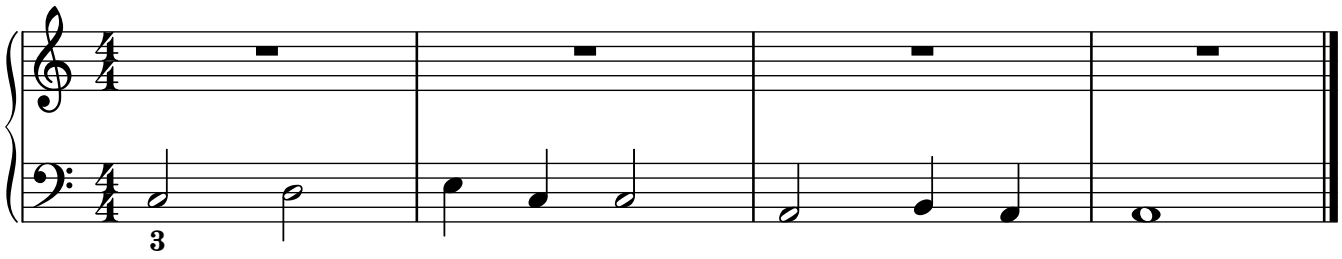
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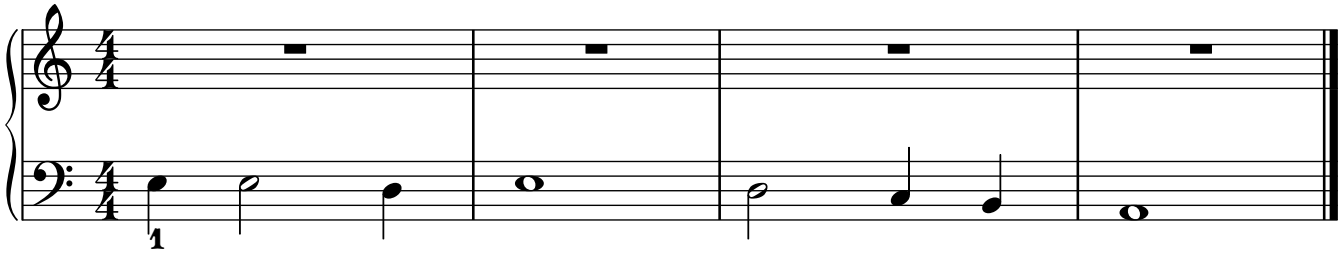
☐ **8.16**



8.17



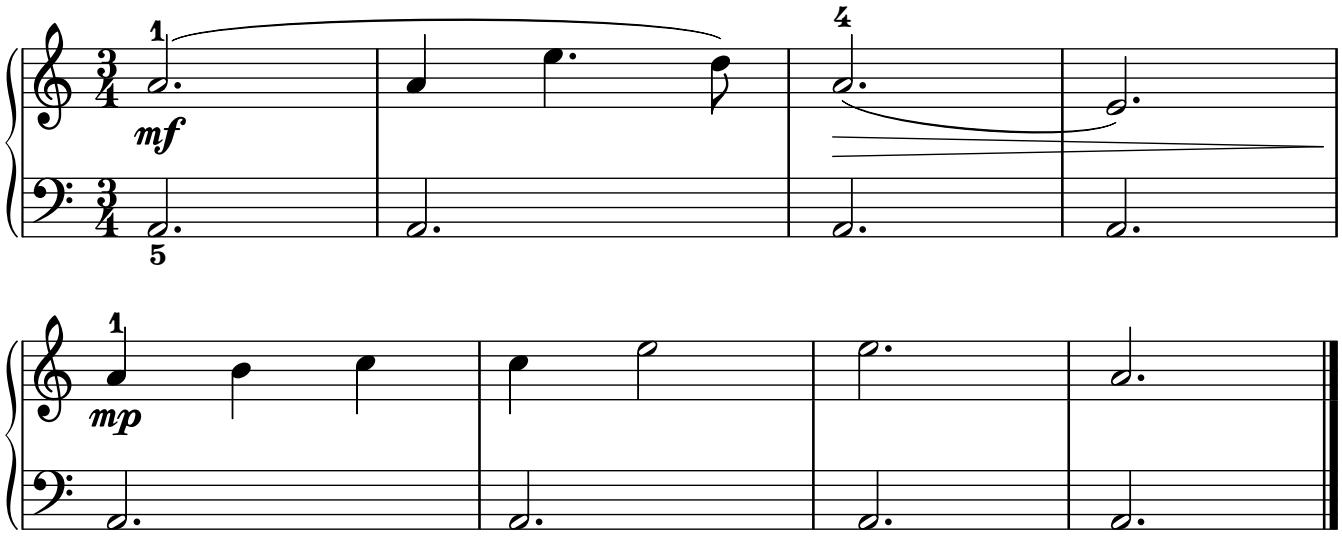
8.18



Part C: A minor, hands together in 3/4 ♩ = 72

Hands together in 3/4; the right hand also moves to E position.

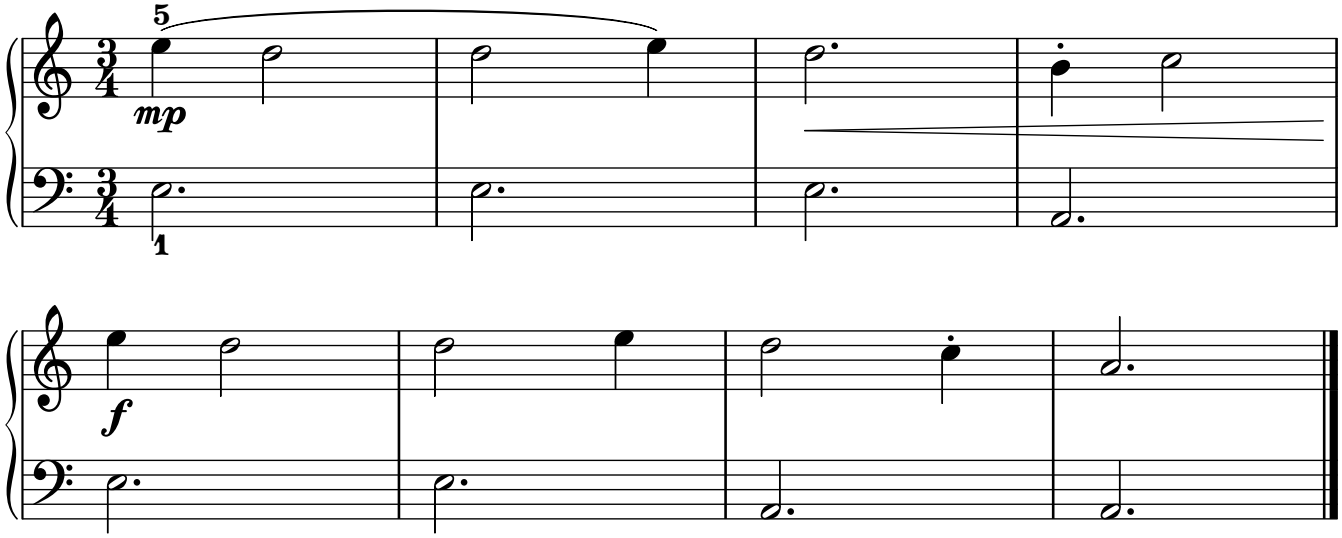
☐ **8.19**



☐ **8.20**



☐ **8.21**



8.22



8.23



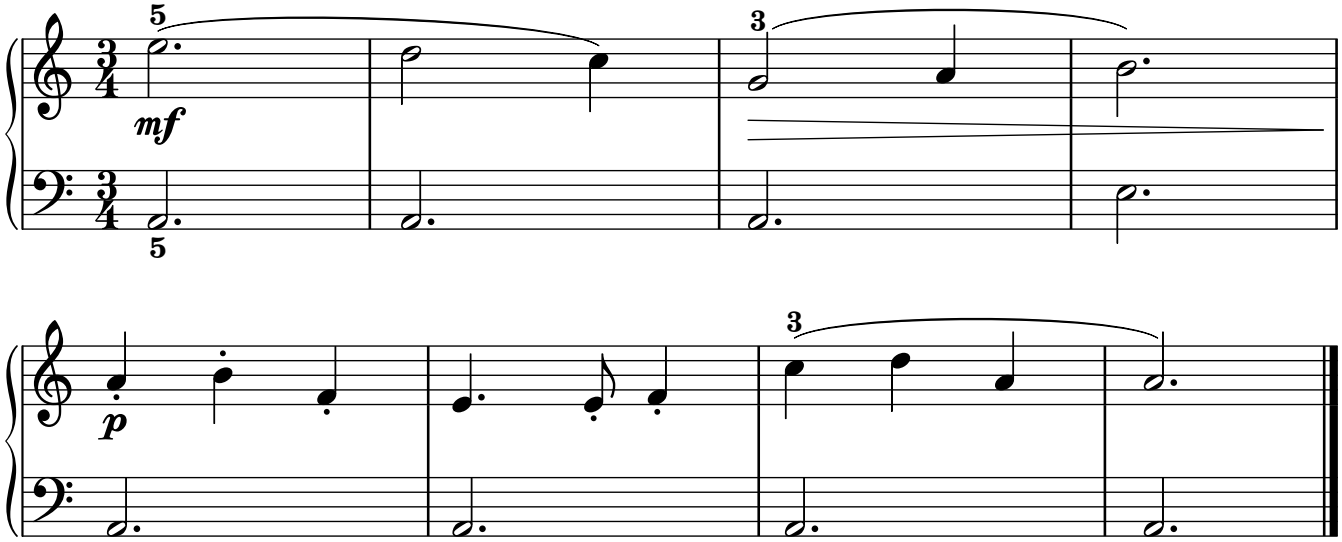
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8.25



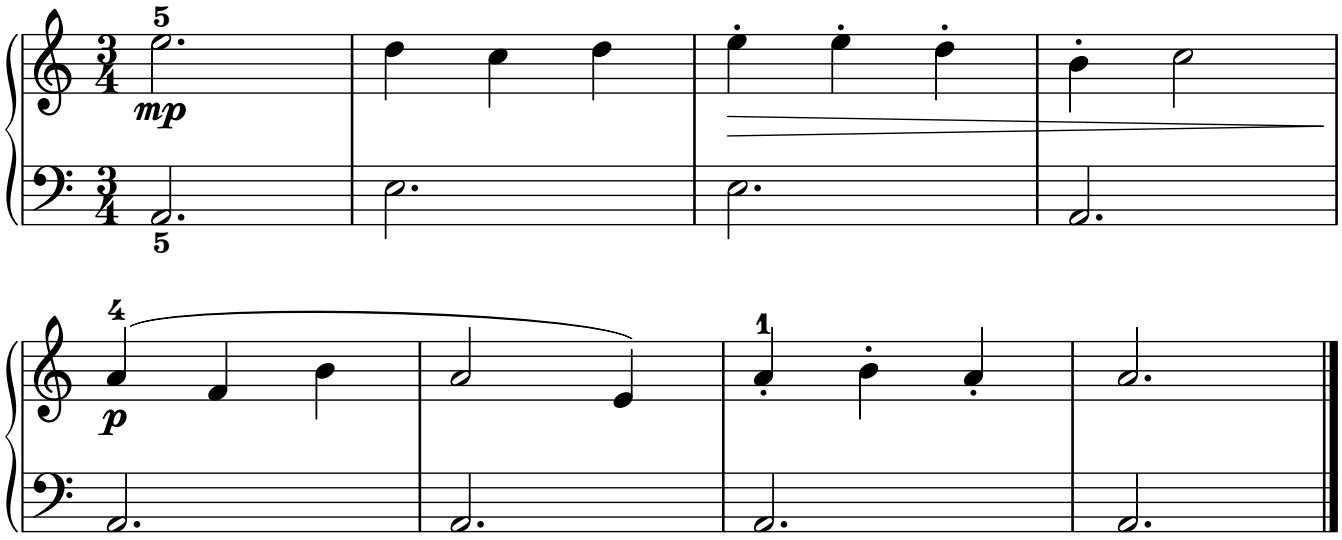
8.26



8.27



8.28



8.29



8.30



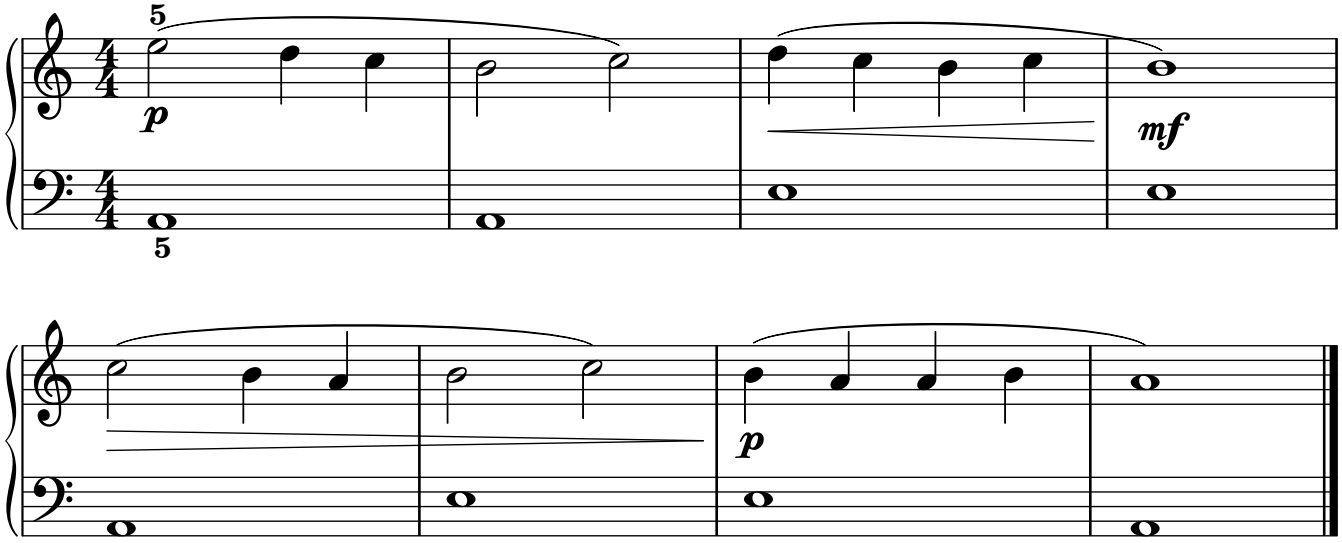
Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Lament ♩ = 66

Original

A slow, singing tune. Each two-bar slur is one breath; let the crescendo in bar 3 lead to mezzo forte.



Shadow Dance ♩ = 84

Original

A minor waltz that climbs the chain A-C-E in the first bar.



Low Road in A Minor ♩ = 72

Original

For the left hand alone, in A position from the bottom space of the bass staff.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 9?

- Play five Part C exercises you have not played before, at 72 beats per minute.
- Pass if you name the key (A minor) before you start, and the shifts to E position land on time.
- Pass if you play no more than one stop per exercise, and at least 9 notes out of 10 are right.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 9.